Table 2. Ratio of the incidence of Brazilian contractors within each continent

Continent	Number of Countries	Countries with contracts with Brazilian contractors	Ratio
Africa	54	17	31.5%
Central America	20	8	40%
North America	3	2	66.7%
South America	12	11	91.7%
Asia	50	8	15%
Europa	46	5	10.9%
Oceania	14	0	0%
Total:	**199**	**51**	

Source: The IBGE website was consulted for the number of countries per continent. http://www.ibge.gov.br/ accessed on 10 March 2014.

2010. In fact, only the two independent Guyanese countries out of all 11 South American countries had fewer than 10 contracts with Brazilian contractors: Surinam, where there was only one contract up until 2010, and Guyana, where no contracts had been signed.

Thus we find South America predominates in terms of the number of contracts by continent. It is also here that half of all Brazilian civil construction firms' overseas contracts are located. Africa stands out as the second region of preference for Brazilian contractor activity, with a total of 73 contracts or 19.8% of all overseas contracts. North America follows with basically 40 contracts in the United States, nine in Mexico and none in Canada. The European data can also be confusing if one does not pay proper attention to it. This is because of the 41 contracts on the continent, 35 are in Portugal, basically concentrated in the activities of the Odebrecht and Andrade Gutierrez subsidiaries in the country. Thus, Brazilian firms' entrance into the continent is highly limited by barriers and mechanisms impeding their insertion. There are, therefore, no works by Brazilian contractors in the large and important markets of France or Italy, given their protectionist policies and those of other European countries. Another region presenting difficulties for Brazilian contractors is Asia, where their presence is reduced. Despite the somewhat restricted number of contracts in the Middle East, the region is extremely attractive as a market for Brazilian